

HUMAN TORCH

The Super Hero who is literally "hot stuff!"

HUMAN TORCH

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Jonathan Lowell Spencer Storm

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT

170 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four #1

(November 1961)



The Human Torch can generate and control fire from any part of his body.

FATEFUL FLIGHT

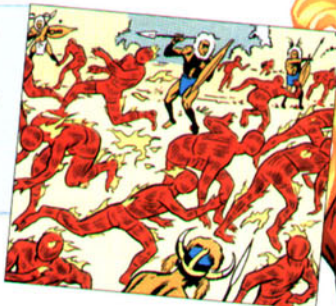
While a teenager, Johnny went to California to visit his sister Susan who had moved out west to become an actress. Susan Storm (INVISIBLE WOMAN) was engaged to marry a brilliant physicist and engineer named Reed Richards (MISTER FANTASTIC). Richards was developing a starship that would be capable of exploring other galaxies.

While Johnny was in California, the government threatened to cut off Richards' funding and so he decided to prove his ship's worth by taking it on a test flight to the stars. Reed's best friend Ben Grimm (THE THING) piloted the craft. Susan and Johnny insisted on coming along.

In space, inadequate shielding on the starship allowed a huge dose of cosmic radiation to bombard the crew. They managed to return to earth using the autopilot, but all four were changed forever.

The cosmic rays altered Johnny's genetic structure allowing him to create fiery plasma that covered his entire body in flames without causing him harm.

The Human Torch creates multiple flaming images of himself in an attempt to escape from fireproof natives with poison-tipped spears.



Following exposure to cosmic radiation, Johnny Storm's body burst into flame.

Johnny Storm and his older sister Susan grew up on Long Island, New York, the children of a doctor and his wife. In spite of the fact that Johnny's mother was killed in a car crash when he was nine years old, the boy developed a passion and skill for building, fixing, and driving cars. He overhauled his first transmission at the age of 15. The following year his father bought him his first hot rod.

Able to control heat energy and cover his body with fiery plasma for over 16 hours before needing to rest, for about 12 hours. He can release a single "Nova-burst" which strikes with the force of a nuclear warhead. The Torch can create shapes from flame, including letters which burn in the sky for 3 minutes. He can also control the temperature of objects with his mind. Clothing is made of special fire-resistant fabric.

ALLIES Invisible Woman, the Thing, Mr. Fantastic, Lyja the Laserist, Alicia Masters, Spider-Man.

FOES Doctor Doom, Onslaught, Gormu, Frightful Four, Galactus.

When Johnny Storm's sister, Sue, accompanied her fiancé, Reed Richards, into space, Johnny insisted on tagging along. Transformed into the Human Torch, he battled the Mole Man.



Exposure to oxygen caused the photoelectric cells in the original Human Torch's skin to burst into flame, to the surprise of the android and its creator.

THE FIRST HUMAN TORCH

The original Human Torch was an android, created by Professor Phineas T. Horton. But the professor's dream of creating a perfect human being failed when the android's body, which was covered in photoelectric solar cells, burst into flames on contact with oxygen. Astonishingly, the android itself was not harmed by the fire. At first the public labeled this Human Torch a menace. The Torch then rejected his creator's "ownership," claiming he didn't want to be a "slave" to someone more concerned about his own fame than about his creation's well-being.

Once he learned to control his flames, the Human Torch vowed never to use his power for evil or harm, and he became a crimefighter. When World War II broke out, the Human Torch teamed with other super heroes, using his abilities to fight the Axis Powers.

In modern times, the Human Torch worked with Heroes for Hire, the West Coast Avengers and even the Fantastic Four. At one point, Immortus split the Torch into two bodies, one of which became the Vision. As part of a new team of Invaders the Torch sacrificed himself to save his teammates' lives.

Fighting fire with fire: the original Human Torch faces off against Johnny Storm, the Human Torch of Fantastic Four fame!

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Fantastic Four #4** The Human Torch quits the Fantastic Four. He meets the Sub-Mariner (for the first time since the reveal of both characters), who threatens the human race.
- **Essential Fantastic Four Vols. 1-3 (tpb)** The Human Torch's classic adventures with the Fantastic Four.
- **The Essential Human Torch Vol. 1 (tpb)** A collection of some of the Human Torch's key adventures.
- **Human Torch Vol. 1: Burn (tpb)** A fiery tale, in which Johnny's high-school rival reappears in his life years later.
- **Spider-Man/Human Torch #1-5** The Human Torch teams up with Spider-Man in those new adventures.

He also discovered that he was able to fly, shoot flames, and absorb heat.

Calling themselves the Fantastic Four, the transformed astronauts decided to team up and use their new powers to help humankind. Johnny chose to call himself the Human Torch, the same name used by an android hero of the 1940s.

For a while, Johnny tried living with his sister on Long Island, attempting to complete high school while at the same time trying to keep that fact he was the Human Torch a secret. This proved far more difficult than he had anticipated. After he finished high school, Johnny moved into



The Human Torch can release concussive blasts of heat energy, each packing a powerful punch.

the Baxter Building, the Fantastic Four's original headquarters in New York City.

LOVE RIVALS

Johnny always loved to tease the unfortunate Thing, Ben Grimm, who was easily angered and jealous of Johnny's good looks and charm. Still, they felt a great affection for each other. This however was greatly strained when Johnny fell in love with and eventually married the blind sculptress Alicia Masters, the only woman that had ever returned Ben's affection.

Later, Alicia MASTERS was revealed to be a SKRULL spy named LYJA, a deception that devastated Johnny.

During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), Johnny took a beating at the hands of an angry mob. When he awoke, he joined Captain America's resistance. Recently, during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7), he had a chance to settle matters with his Lyja, who teleported the upper part of the Baxter Building—along with Johnny, the Thing, and Franklin and Valeria Richards—into the Negative Zone. **MT, MF**



Flaming on (except for his left arm), Johnny rescues a woman from an attacking Sentinel.